



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*pathyaṃ pūtaṃ anāyastam āhāryaṃ sāttvikaṃ smṛtaṃ |
rājasaṃ cendriya-preṣṭhaṃ tāmasaṃ cārtidāśuci ||
dravyaṃ deśas tathā kālo jñānaṃ karma ca kārakaḥ |
śraddhāvasthā-kṛtir niṣṭhā traiguṇyaḥ sarva eva hi ||
sarve guṇamayā bhāvāḥ puruṣāvyakta-dhiṣṭhitāḥ |
dṛṣṭaṃ śrutam anudhyātaṃ buddhyā vā puruṣarṣabha ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Food, pure and wholesome, easily obtained, is considered sattvic, nourishing goodness within. Food that pleases the senses, overly rich, is rajasic, fueling passion and attachment. Food that is stale, impure, and causes pain is tamasic, binding you to darkness and inertia. Consider also the substance, the place, and the time; knowledge, action, and the doer themselves, all imbued with these qualities. Your faith, your state of being, your actions, your steadfastness – all are influenced by the three gunas, the fundamental qualities of nature. Everything is comprised of these qualities, residing within the interplay of the individual and the unmanifested. Whatever you see, hear, contemplate, or understand, O Arjuna, is shaped by this dynamic.

This passage calls you to a deeper awareness of the subtle forces shaping your reality. It isn't just about what you eat; it's about the quality of everything you consume – your thoughts, your relationships, your experiences. Are they nourishing your spirit, igniting restlessness, or dragging you down? By understanding the gunas, you gain the power to consciously cultivate sattva, the quality of purity, balance, and clarity, in all aspects of your life.

In modern life, bombarded by sensory overload and constant stimulation, this wisdom is more relevant than ever. It encourages you to be mindful of the media you consume, the company you keep, and the choices you make. Are you feeding your mind with negativity, or are you seeking out sources of inspiration and truth? Are you pursuing fleeting pleasures, or are you cultivating lasting peace and fulfillment? By aligning your actions with sattva, you can navigate the complexities of the world with greater ease and grace, creating a life that is both meaningful and fulfilling.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small, conscious choice can you make today to cultivate more sattva in your life and move closer to a state of inner peace?